ples of universalism, is tantamount to accusing them of violating the French republican social contract.

What makes this return of universalism in a certain segment of the far left interesting is its novelty. Since the late 1960s, the far left has much more often advocated for universalism's opposite—the "droit à la différence," the right to difference, for minorities in France. The defense of universalism has been more common in the center (both center left and center right) of political discourse in France, including and perhaps especially among those who denounce the "new antisemitism," such as Alain Finkielkraut and Pierre-André Taguieff. Their concern over Muslim antisemitism often accompanies support for laws restricting the wearing of the veil in schools, which many of them see as the sign of a dangerous communitarianism invading the public sphere.[4]

It is striking, then, to see far left apologists for violence against Jews invoke the same rhetoric of universalism and the same spectre of communitarianism as their adversaries. For some of these far-left thinkers, such invocations serve a clearly cynical function: they allow them to accuse their accusers of the same fault for which they are being accused, thus negating the initial accusation. Tariq Ramadan, for example, a Muslim theologian in Switzerland, published an essay in 2003 entitled, "Critique of the (new) communitarian intellectuals," which accuses those who denounce the "new antisemitism" of acting out of narrowly Jewish interests.

> For a few years now (even before the second intifada), some French Jewish intellectuals who had previously been considered universalist thinkers began, both on the national and international stages, to develop analyses that are increasingly driven by a communitarian impulse that tends to relativize the defense of the universal principles of equality or justice.[5]

And Ramadan names names: in addition to his principle targets, Pierre-André Taguieff and Alain Finkielkraut, he includes Bernard-Henri Lévy, Alexandre Adler, Bernard Kouchner, and André Glucksmann. One must admire Ramadan's audacity in accusing his opponents of breaking the rules of French universalism while himself violating one of its major taboos by categorizing thinkers in terms of their religious or ethnic background.

According to Ramadan, the proof that these "French Jewish intellectuals," especially Finkielkraut, have betrayed universalism is that they are not neutral on the Israel-Palestinian conflict.

> The debate is no longer based on universal principles and even if he pretends to be linked to the common European tradition, his position

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